

JEREL SAFFORD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT support and operations professional with 10+ years of experience troubleshooting technical issues, training users, managing multi-system environments and supporting day-to-day business operations. Currently pursuing CCNA certification with hands-on experience in networking labs. Windows and Linux environments, device configuration and basic system administration.

Known for strong customer communication, fast learning, and the ability to diagnose issues across hardware, software, networking and user workflows. Experienced supporting end users, documenting processes, managing escalations and adapting quickly to new systems and technologies.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Operating Systems: Windows 10/11, Linux (WSL,Ubuntu), iOS, Android OS

Programming & Scripting: HTML, CSS, basic Python, basic JavaScript

Networking: TCP/IP, VLAN fundamentals, subnetting, DHCP, DNS, VPNs, Wi-Fi troubleshooting, SSH, basic routing and switching concepts, connectivity diagnostics

Tools & Platforms: WSL, PowerShell, Remote Support Tools, CRM platforms, DDI knowledge, Panorama exposure, BlueCat, POS systems, ticket documentation, Microsoft 365, Google Workplace

Hands-On Labs & Projects: Packet Tracer, EVE-NG labs, CCNA studies, device configuration, Linux terminal navigation, SSH connectivity, network troubleshooting

PROJECTS & HANDS-ON EXPERIENCE

CCNA Networking Labs & Homelab (Ongoing)

- Building and troubleshooting networking labs using Packet Tracer and EVE-NG environments.
- Configured VLANs, trunk ports, inter-VLAN routing, DHCP relay, static routes and basic routing protocols.
- Practiced troubleshooting connectivity issues involving DNS, DHCP, routing paths and network segmentation.
- Worked with simulated enterprise-style environments including switches, routers, wireless infrastructure and firewall concepts.

- Developed foundational understanding of TCP/IP, subnetting, NAT, VPNs, and network troubleshooting workflows.

Linux/WSL Environment Administration

- Configured Ubuntu through WSL for command-line administration and networking practice.
- Utilized Linux networking tools and SSH for remote connectivity and system interaction.
- Practiced terminal navigation, packet management, process monitoring and system configuration tasks.

Technical Troubleshooting & Device Support

- Resolved software, connectivity, storage and configuration issues across Windows, Android and Chromebook devices.
- Assisted users with system resets, updates, account configuration , VPN-related conflicts and application troubleshooting.
- Researched and resolved Wi-Fi connectivity restrictions and device communication issues.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Contractor / Technical Training Participant — Clearwater, FL

10/2025 – Present

- Performed independent contract and gig-based work, including logistics, delivery, warehouse, and customer service assignments while pursuing advanced networking and infrastructure studies.
- Participated in CCNA-focused training programs emphasizing routing, switching, troubleshooting, network operations, and enterprise support concepts.
- Assisted training staff with validation and quality review of new lab modules prior to student rollout by identifying configuration errors, documentation inconsistencies, and troubleshooting issues.
- Executed and verified lab exercises involving VLANs, routing, DHCP, DNS, SSH connectivity and network troubleshooting workflows.
- Provided feedback on training materials, procedural accuracy and lab functionality to improve student learning outcomes.

Store Manager — Metro by T-Mobile, St. Petersburg, FL

06/2025 – 12/2025

- Supported device provisioning, account configuration and connectivity troubleshooting across multiple systems.
- Troubleshoot device, SIM, and network issues; guided users through resets, updates, and configurations.
- Maintained accurate system records, digital inventory tracking and issue documentation.
- Resolved escalated service issues by diagnosing hardware, account, or connectivity problems.

Training Manager — Knighted Gaming, Tampa, FL

06/2023 – 08/2024

- Trained 500+ employees across 15 locations on systems, workflows, compliance tools, and standard procedures.
- Created onboarding documentation, surveys, and training materials.
- Coordinated system access, scheduling, and technical requirements for new hires.

- Assessed operational gaps and aligned training to process needs.

Operations Manager — Knighted Gaming, Pensacola/Tampa, FL

11/2020 – 06/2023

- Oversaw operations for 85 employees using software platforms for audits, logs, and productivity tracking.
- Conducted performance reviews using digital tools and documented improvement plans.
- Managed supply chain and inventory systems to prevent discrepancies.
- Led compliance reviews and system-driven validation steps.

Development Supervisor — Knighted Gaming, Tampa, FL

03/2019 – 11/2020

- Managed logistics across 15 locations using internal systems and scheduling tools.
 - Documented new workflows and supported system updates for team adoption.
 - Led onboarding workshops and digital training sessions.
 - Monitored system outputs for errors, compliance risks, or irregular activity.
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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts – English Literature

University of South Florida — Tampa, FL

06/2014